

Appendix F - Math and Derivative Helpers

Numeric and string helpers BASIC provides at the prompt. Each one is documented in full in Chapter 2; this appendix is the single-page reference.

F.1 Numeric functions

Function	Domain	Result
ABS(<i>x</i>)	any number	Absolute value $ x $.
SGN(<i>x</i>)	any number	-1 if $x < 0$, 0 if $x = 0$, 1 if $x > 0$.
INT(<i>x</i>)	any number	Largest integer not exceeding <i>x</i> .
SQR(<i>x</i>)	$x \geq 0$	Square root.
EXP(<i>x</i>)	any number	e^x .
LOG(<i>x</i>)	$x > 0$	Natural logarithm.
SIN(<i>x</i>)	radians	Sine.
COS(<i>x</i>)	radians	Cosine.
TAN(<i>x</i>)	radians	Tangent.
ATN(<i>x</i>)	any number	Arctangent, result in $(-\pi/2, \pi/2)$.
RND(<i>x</i>)	sign-sensitive	$x > 0$: next pseudo-random in $[0, 1)$. $x = 0$: repeat last value. $x < 0$: reseed with INT(<i>x</i>) and emit first draw.
FRE(<i>x</i>)	argument ignored	Bytes of free BASIC program / variable storage.
POS(<i>x</i>)	argument ignored	Current cursor column on the terminal.
USR(<i>x</i>)	any number	Call user machine-code routine; see DEF USR in Chapter 2.
PEEK(<i>a</i>)	address	32-bit aligned read of memory at <i>a</i> .
PEEK8(<i>a</i>)	address	Byte-width read.
DEEK(<i>a</i>)	address	16-bit aligned read (low half).
LEEK(<i>a</i>)	address	32-bit aligned read (same as PEEK).

F.2 String functions

Function	Result
LEN(<i>s</i> \$)	Number of bytes in <i>s</i> \$.
VAL(<i>s</i> \$)	Numeric value parsed from the start of <i>s</i> \$.
ASC(<i>s</i> \$)	ASCII code of the first byte of <i>s</i> \$.
CHR\$(<i>n</i>)	One-byte string with ASCII code <i>n</i> .

Function	Result
STR\$(n)	Decimal text form of n, with a leading space for non-negative numbers.
LEFT\$(s\$, n)	First n bytes of s\$.
RIGHT\$(s\$, n)	Last n bytes of s\$.
MID\$(s\$, p[, n])	n bytes of s\$ starting at byte position p (1-based). With one argument, returns everything from p to the end.
SPC(n)	n spaces; only valid inside PRINT.
TAB(n)	Move cursor to column n; only valid inside PRINT.
HEX\$(n)	Uppercase hexadecimal text form of n.
BIN\$(n)	Binary text form of n.
OCT\$(n)	Octal text form of n.

F.3 Derived identities

These are not separate functions: they are equivalences a program can rely on when composing the helpers above.

Wanted	Compute as
natural log	$\text{LOG}(x)$
base-10 log	$\text{LOG}(x) / \text{LOG}(10)$
base-2 log	$\text{LOG}(x) / \text{LOG}(2)$
arcsine of x	$\text{ATN}(x / \text{SQR}(1 - x*x))$
arccosine of x	$1.5707963 - \text{ATN}(x / \text{SQR}(1 - x*x))$
modulo	$x - \text{INT}(x / m) * m$
ceiling	$-\text{INT}(-x)$
round to nearest	$\text{INT}(x + 0.5)$ (for $x \geq 0$)
fractional part	$x - \text{INT}(x)$
min(a,b)	$(a + b - \text{ABS}(a - b)) / 2$
max(a,b)	$(a + b + \text{ABS}(a - b)) / 2$
pi	$4 * \text{ATN}(1)$
e	$\text{EXP}(1)$

F.4 Range and precision

All numeric functions return BASIC's 32-bit float. The trigonometric helpers accept any radian argument; large arguments lose precision in the usual way (the result is reduced modulo $2*\pi$ before the polynomial evaluation, so an argument of $1E9$ gives a value with very few correct significant digits). Programs that need accuracy across many octaves of input should fold the argument into $[-\pi, \pi]$ themselves.

RND is a 32-bit linear-congruential generator. Its sequence is deterministic and reproducible after a RND(-seed) reseed; the first draw immediately after the reseed depends on seed and the generator's fixed multiplier.